

Narrow-Band Exclusion and the (D, ε) Phase Diagram

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Abstract

We combine the repetition-rigidity theorem of the Finite Spectral Shadows program with a ballot-type count of discrepancy-confined valuation words. The count grows at rate $\lambda(D)$, computed by strip transfer matrices, and crosses the band capacity 2 at $D^* = 1.232$ (multiplicative band ratio $2^{2D^*} \approx 5.5$). Consequence: a *divergent* positive Syracuse orbit cannot dwell in any band of ratio < 5.5 at height Y for more than $O(Y^{\theta(D)})$ steps, $\theta(D) = \ln \lambda(D) / \ln 2 < 1$ — unconditionally. For bands of ratio $\lesssim 2.1$ the same squeeze excludes cycles as well, via the Baker bound. Tilting the transfer matrix by the non-coboundary shadow observable extends λ to $\lambda_{\text{eff}}(D, \varepsilon)$ and produces a phase diagram in the (band-width, bias) plane whose excluded region covers all narrow bands and all wide bands of bias $\gtrsim 0.5$: counterexample windows are confined to wide bands with low local bias, so the global bias demanded by the keystone arrow must concentrate in band crossings.

1 The strip count

For a valuation word $w = (b_1, \dots, b_p)$ write $S_j = \sum_{i \leq j} (\log_2 3 - b_i)$ and call w *D-confined* if $|S_j| \leq D$ for all $j \leq p$. Let $N_D(p)$ denote the number of *D*-confined words of length p .

Lemma 1 (Strip growth rate). *$N_D(p) \leq C_D \lambda_\delta(D + \delta)^p$ for every grid step $\delta > 0$, where $\lambda_\delta(D)$ is the Perron root of the δ -coarsened strip transfer graph (states: grid points of $[-D, D]$; one edge per letter b with shift $\log_2 3 - b$, endpoints rounded outward). The bracketing is monotone in D and converges as $\delta \downarrow 0$. Computed values ($\delta = 10^{-2}$):*

D	0.5	0.8	1.0	1.232	1.5	2.0	3.0	∞
$\lambda(D)$	1.00	1.50	1.75	2.00	2.14	2.35	2.56	2.78

with $\lambda(\infty) = e^{h_0}$, h_0 the max entropy of letter laws of mean $\log_2 3$. We write $\theta(D) = \ln \lambda(D) / \ln 2$, so $\theta(D^*) = 1$ at $D^* = 1.232$.

Proof. Any *D*-confined path induces a path on the coarsened graph with widened strip; the number of length- p paths on a finite graph is at most $C\rho^p$ with ρ its Perron root. Monotonicity in D and in δ is immediate from edge inclusion. $\square$

2 Narrow-band dichotomy

Recall the repetition-rigidity theorem: two positions of a positive orbit carrying the same length- p valuation block, lying within 2^{p+1} of each other, are equal (the block class is a single residue class modulo 2^{B_u+1} , $B_u \geq p$).

Theorem 1 (Narrow-band dichotomy). *Let an orbit segment of length M satisfy $x_n \in [Y, 2^{2D}Y]$ throughout, and set $p = \lceil \log_2(Y(2^{2D} - 1)) \rceil$. If*

$$M > C_D \lambda(D)^p + p \asymp C'_D Y^{\theta(D)},$$

then the segment contains two equal points: the orbit is purely periodic — an integer cycle inside the band, of period $\leq M$ and minimum $\geq Y$. Consequently:

- (a) (Unconditional, divergent case.) *A divergent orbit is acyclic, so it can spend at most $C'_D Y^{\theta(D)}$ consecutive steps in any band of ratio $< 2^{2D^*} \approx 5.5$ at height Y .*
- (b) (Full exclusion at very narrow bands.) *If $\theta(D) < 1/(\tau + 1)$ (with $\tau = 13.3$ from the Baker cycle bound $x_{\min} \leq Cp^{\tau+1}$; numerically $D \lesssim 0.55$, band ratio $\lesssim 2.1$), the manufactured cycle has $Y \leq C(C'_D Y^\theta)^{\tau+1} < Y$, a contradiction: no orbit, periodic or not, dwells beyond the bound.*
- (c) (Intermediate regime.) *For $\theta \in [1/(\tau + 1), 1)$ the residual object is a high cycle with period pinned to $[(Y/C)^{1/(\tau+1)}, C'_D Y^\theta]$ — the classical cycle problem, quantitatively localized.*

Proof. The segment's word is D' -confined with $D' \leq D + o(1)$ (the $\log_2(1 + \frac{1}{3x})$ corrections are $O(M/Y)$). Its length- p blocks are $2D$ -confined words, of which there are at most $C\lambda(2D \rightarrow D\text{-bracketing})^p$; with the stated M the pigeonhole yields two positions with equal blocks, and the band diameter $Y(2^{2D} - 1) < 2^{p+1}$ forces equality by repetition rigidity. The corollaries follow as stated. $\square$

Corollary 1 (Bounded-discrepancy exclusion, complexity-free). *No valuation word with $\sup_j |S_j| < D^*$ is realizable by a divergent positive orbit — with no hypothesis on factor complexity. This subsumes the Sturmian exclusion ($D < 1$) of the parent program and removes its subexponential-complexity assumption in the divergent case.*

3 The (D, ε) phase diagram

Tilt the strip transfer matrix by the non-coboundary shadow observable $\phi_\omega(b) = \Re(\omega(\zeta_3^{-b} - \mathbb{E}_{\text{geom}}))$ and define

$$\ln \lambda_{\text{eff}}(D, \varepsilon) = \max_{\omega} \inf_{t \geq 0} [\ln \lambda_t(D, \omega) - t\varepsilon] :$$

the exponential growth rate of D -confined words carrying bias $\geq \varepsilon$. The phase boundary $\lambda_{\text{eff}} = 2$ (Figure 1) runs vertically at D^* for small bias and saturates near $\varepsilon^* \approx 0.5$ for wide bands: *all* narrow bands are excluded, and wide bands tolerate only bias $\lesssim 0.5$. A counterexample's banded windows are therefore confined to the wide-band low-bias region; since the keystone arrow demands a persistent global bias, that bias must be carried by the *band crossings* — the regime of the 2-adic run-length machinery (k consecutive $b = 1$ steps force $x \equiv -1 \pmod{2^{k+1}}$), which is the next target.

Remark. *Constants are computed with outward bracketing at grid 10^{-2} and are believed accurate to the displayed digits; a fully interval-arithmetic certification of $\lambda(D)$ and the boundary curve is routine and deferred. All other ingredients (repetition rigidity; the Baker cycle bound) are proved in the parent program, the former machine-verified in Lean 4.*

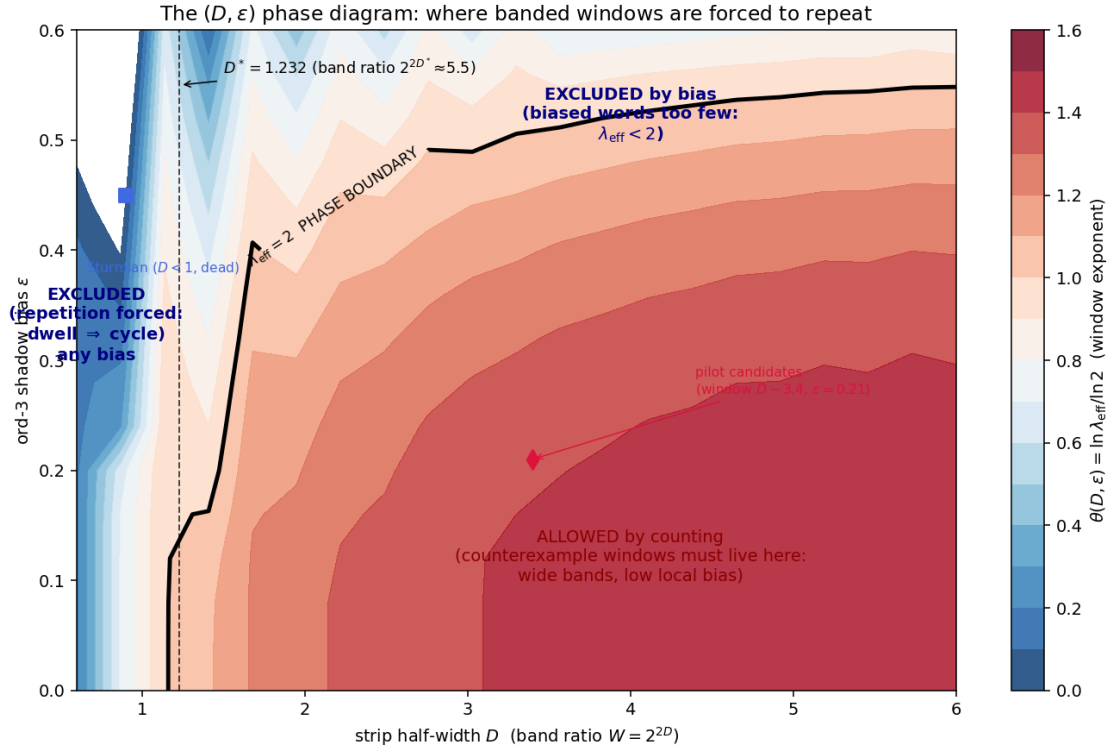


Figure 1: The phase diagram. Blue: excluded by counting (repetition forced). Red: allowed by counting; the pilot candidates' windows sit here and die by 2-adic realizability instead.